

Rafael Montero Salazar

Software Engineer — Full-Stack Developer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- 14+ years of experience across QA, front-end, and full-stack development, including 6+ years building production applications with Vue.js, React, and JavaScript ES6.
- Strong backend skills with Node.js/Express and Java Spring Boot.
- Delivered for enterprise clients — Maxar Technologies, Ford Motors, and Subaru — across geospatial, automotive, and global identity systems.
- Experienced integrating AI tooling (Cursor, Ollama, LangChain/LangGraph) into development workflows to accelerate delivery.
- Manages Docker-based server infrastructure (nginx, MariaDB, Redis, AWS) as a developer/sysadmin, including a self-run WordPress hosting business since 2017.
- Prioritizes client visibility into the development process and clear, well-defined requirements flow across teams and meetings.
- Fully remote-capable and comfortable in direct client-facing roles.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frontend: Vue.js, React, JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, Vanilla JS, Adobe Experience Manager (AEM — HTL, Sling Models, JCR, Clientlibs, Touch UI/Granite UI/Coral UI)

Backend: Node.js, Express, Java, Spring Boot, Python.

Databases: SQL database design and normalization, MariaDB/MySQL, MongoDB (NoSQL — collections and documents)

Frontend Tooling & Libraries: npm, Yarn, Vite, Tailwind CSS, Docusaurus, TanStack Query, Axios

Styling & CSS: SCSS, SASS, Flexbox, CSS Grid, Box Model, CSS Modifiers, Responsive/Mobile-First Design, Cross-Browser & Cross-Device Compatibility, Accessibility (a11y)

Software Engineering Practices: Design Patterns, SOLID Principles, MVC Architecture, Object-Oriented Development, Clean Code, RESTful API Design, Component-Based Architecture, Code Reviews / Pull Requests

Version Control: Git, GitHub, Git Flow, Trunk-Based Development

Communication & Collaboration: Client visibility into development process, clear requirements definition, cross-team meeting facilitation

Agile & Collaboration: Scrum sprints, Jira, Confluence

AI & Tooling: Responsible use of AI-assisted development tools — Cursor, Claude Code, VS Code + Ollama (local models), LangChain, LangGraph, AI agent development

Infrastructure / DevOps: Linux server administration, Bash scripting, Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes (working knowledge), CI/CD pipelines, nginx, UFW, APT, Snap, SSH key-based security, Redis, Let's Encrypt SSL, Grafana (familiarity), VPS administration (Vultr, OVHcloud), AWS (EC2, Lightsail, S3, IAM)

QA & Testing: Manual and automated testing, unit and integration testing (Jest, Vitest, JUnit), Storybook, stubs, dependency mocking, spyOn

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Developer — Gorilla Logic

Project: Internal Project

- Developed React, Python and Node.js applications integrating AI agents built with LangChain and LangGraph.
- Used AI-assisted development tools, including Cursor and VS Code with local Ollama models, to improve development speed and code quality.

Client: Ford Motors

Sep 2023 – Feb 2026

- Maintained and enhanced global Account Identity pages on the Azure platform, supporting users across the Americas, Asia, Europe, and the UAE.
- Built and maintained front-end features using Vanilla JavaScript within a large-scale, multi-region enterprise

application.

- Collaborated with teams across other regions to propose and execute technical solutions.
- Implemented Adobe Analytics tagging tailored by region, country, and language.

Client: Maxar Technologies

Aug 2022 – Sep 2023

- Contributed to SecureWatch, a geospatial platform delivering Earth imagery and geospatial information, using Vue.js on the front end and Java Spring on the back end.
- Worked within a containerized development environment using Docker and Kubernetes as part of the team's deployment workflow.
- Participated in the development of the Maxar Developer Portal using Vue.js and Docusaurus.
- Developed client-facing communication skills through direct participation in client meetings, providing visibility into the development process and proposing effective technical solutions.

Web Developer — Accenture

Aug 2018 – Aug 2022

- Worked on the Subaru.com website for client Subaru, part of a client engagement spanning nearly 8 years across QA and development roles.
- Contributed to a front-end redesign project built with Vue.js and Adobe Experience Manager (AEM), working with AEM technologies including HTL (HTML Template Language), Sling Models, JCR concepts, Clientlibs, and Touch UI Dialogs (Granite UI and Coral UI).
- Built cross-browser, cross-device compatible interfaces using a mobile-first, responsive web development approach.
- Applied modern web development practices including MVC architecture and object-oriented development principles.

QA Analyst — Accenture

Jan 2015 – Aug 2018

- Performed manual and automated testing for the Subaru.com website.

QA Analyst — Critech Research

Nov 2011 – Jan 2015

- Conducted manual testing of medical devices for clients including Mindray, Bayer, and Abbott.

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS & SIDE BUSINESS

Founder — Web Hosting & Infrastructure (Self-Employed)

2017 – Present

- Run a part-time side business hosting WordPress sites in Docker containers across multiple VPS providers (Vultr, OVHcloud, AWS), including Eurekafoods, Boutique Galatea, Alcala Novias, and Lucci Boutique.
- Administer Linux servers end-to-end: nginx configuration, UFW firewall rules, and package management via APT and Snap.
- Harden server access with SSH key-based authentication and IP banning/blocking for unauthorized access attempts.
- Use Cloudflare as CDN and proxy for performance, security, and traffic management.

Full-Stack Developer — Boutique Galatea (Wedding Dress Management System)

2018 – Present

- Built and maintain a full-stack application using Vue 3 and Java Spring Boot 3 to manage wedding dress inventory and operations for a major Costa Rica retail store.
- In production since 2018; upgraded to the latest framework versions in 2024.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Software Systems

Universidad Latina, Heredia, Costa Rica — 2007 – 2011

Licenciatura in Software Systems, emphasis in QA/QC (coursework completed, thesis pending)

Universidad Fidelitas, Costa Rica — 2016 – 2018

LANGUAGES

Spanish (Native) | English (C1 – Advanced) | Russian (Basic)